

Sparsh Khanchandani: 8

*Ichcha on
Uttaran, Colors*

She may dream of being an IAS officer, but for now Sparsh Purushottam Khanchandani is thrilled to have the camera on her toothy face. As the tiny *Ichcha on Colors' Uttaran*, the pigtailed Sparsh, who plays the daughter of a domestic help, has become everyone's favourite underdog. But showbiz isn't easy. The daughter of an accountant in the Ministry of Defence and a teacher who's given up her job to be with her star child, eight-year-old Sparsh has a packed day. Living in the satellite town of Ulhasnagar near Mumbai means that she completes school in the morning and shoots for close to seven hours for which she earns Rs 7,000 per episode. "It's weird but people actually ask us if we've stuck on her two front teeth to make her look like Darsheel Safary," says an amused Ashwini Yardi of Colors. Her teeth have also become her identity, part of her new-found fame. "I've recently started writing, 'With Love, Sparsh', when I give autographs," she grins.

SHRUTI PATEL/SHUTTER

